

GLAZING & IMPASTO

GLAZING IS A USEFUL WAY of enriching or deepening the tone of a color. A glaze is a thin layer of transparent oil color that is applied over an existing area of dry paint.

The color is generally mixed first with an oil painting medium, which helps to adapt its consistency and increase its transparency. A glaze can also serve as a form of color mixing (see p.18),



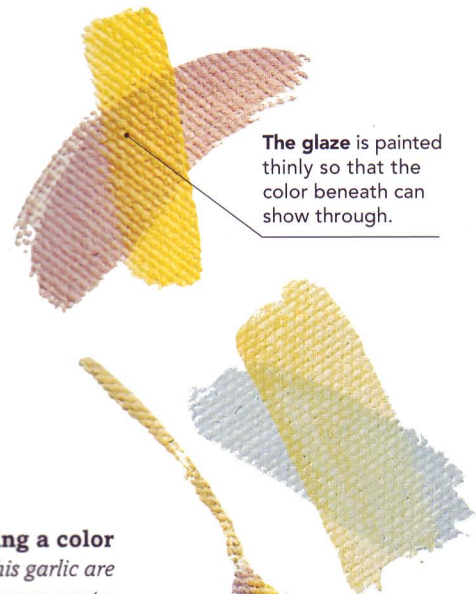
A glaze enriches another color

Glazing

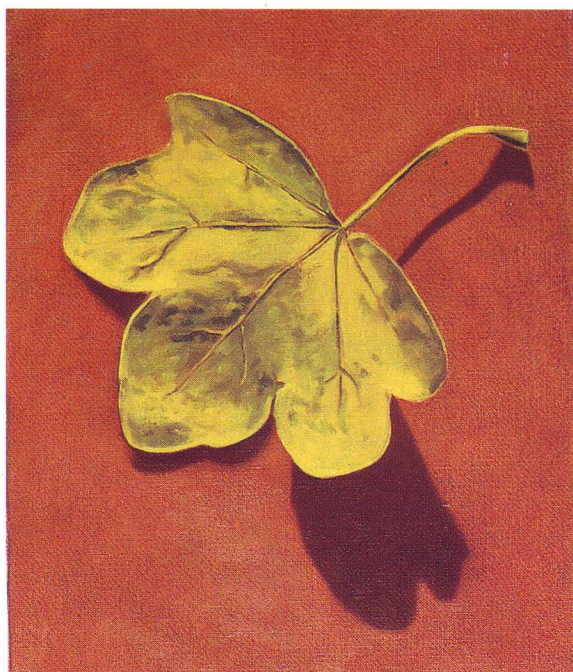
Glazing can be used for a number of color effects, as its transparent quality allows the layer of paint underneath it to remain visible. Several successive layers of rich transparent glazes can achieve a wonderfully deep, luminous effect in a painting. A glaze also brings a particular unity and harmony to a work with its uniform covering. The paint should be mixed with an oil

painting medium (a mixture of stand oil and white spirit or turpentine) until it forms a puree like consistency, and then applied to the surface of a painting with a soft hair or bristle brush. Once the glaze has been applied, it can be smoothed into an even layer over the surface using a clean dry round brush. For large areas, a shaving brush is useful (see p.58). Before glazing, always make sure the existing paint layer is dry.

so that a thin red glaze over a layer of dried yellow paint produces an orange color quite different in appearance from a physically mixed orange. Impasto, on the other hand, is a technique of applying a color very thickly so that a surface retains the character and shape of each brushstroke. Oil paint has a good viscous quality suitable for impasto, so it is usually applied straight from the tube with a painting knife or a bristle brush. Impasto produces a fresh, vigorously textured look.



The glaze is painted thinly so that the color beneath can show through.



Deepening a color

The tones on this garlic are given depth, and the image greater substance, using transparent glazes.

Producing harmony

This leaf study has first been painted in a range of tones of one color, or "monochromatically," using Burnt Umber mixed with Titanium White for an opaque effect. When this was dry, a glaze of Winsor Green has been applied over the surface of the leaf, with Cadmium Lemon for the highlights.



Touches of dark transparent Winsor Green are applied to the shadowy areas of the leaf.

